PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week 3 | Lesson 4

THE PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE

Learning objectives

- Explain the meaning of the past continuous tense.

- Recognise and use the correct sentence patterns.

- Write clear and correct sentences in this lesson.

Meaning

The past continuous describes an activity that was going on at a particular time in the past.

Important rules

- Form: subject + was/were + verb-ing.

- Use was with I, he, she and it; use were with you, we and they.

- Use was/were not + verb-ing for negatives.

Examples

1. I was reading at seven o'clock.

2. They were weeding the school garden.

3. The baby was sleeping.

4. We were singing during assembly.

5. Was she writing a letter?

6. The children were not shouting.

Worked example

Question: Make negative: She was dancing.

Answer: She was not dancing.

Common mistakes

Incorrect	Correct
She were running.	She was running.
They was reading.	They were reading.
I was play football.	I was playing football.
Were he working?	Was he working?

PRACTICE EXERCISES

A. Complete the sentences or expressions.

1. At noon, Musa ___ (eat) lunch.

_____

2. The girls ___ (sing) at assembly.

_____

3. I ___ (write) at six o'clock.

_____

4. The dog ___ (sleep).

_____

5. You ___ (walk) home.

_____

6. We ___ (clean) the compound.

_____

B. Rewrite or correct as instructed.

7. Make negative: She was dancing.

_____

_____

8. Make a question: They were working.

_____

_____

9. Begin with I: I read a book at 8 p.m. yesterday.

_____

_____

10. Correct: He were crying.

_____

_____

C. Find and correct the mistakes.

11. She were running.

_____

12. They was reading.

_____

13. I was play football.

_____

14. Were he working?

_____

D. Read and answer.

15. State one important rule from this lesson.

_____

_____

16. Write one correct example related to this lesson.

_____

_____

17. Explain the meaning of the grammar form studied.

_____

_____

E. Write your own sentences.

18. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

19. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

20. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

Remember

- Form: subject + was/were + verb-ing.

- Use was with I, he, she and it; use were with you, we and they.

- Use was/were not + verb-ing for negatives.